Jessie Trudeau

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Appointments

2023- **Syracuse University**, Assistant Professor
Department of Political Science, Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs

2022-23 **Brown University**, Postdoctoral Fellow
Center for Philosophy, Politics, and Economics

Education

2022 Harvard University, Ph.D., A.M., Government
2015 Stanford University, M.A., International Policy (International Political Economy)
2011 Vanderbilt University, B.S., Human and Organizational Development, Spanish

Book Project

In progress *Machine Gun Politics: Why Politicians Cooperate with Criminal Groups*
– Awards: Best dissertation in the *Urban Politics* APSA Section and the *Democracy and Autocracy* APSA Section (Runner-up)

Peer-Reviewed Publications

2026 Trudeau, J. "How Criminal Governance Undermines Elections." ***American Journal of Political Science***. *Forthcoming.*
– Awards: Pi Sigma Alpha Best Conference Paper, APSA; Conflict Processes Section Best Paper, APSA; Elinor and Vincent Ostrom Best Graduate Student Paper, PCS
– Press: Piauí, Pindograma, Scope Conditions

2022 Trudeau, J. "Limiting Aggressive Policing Can Reduce Police and Civilian Violence." ***World Development*** 105961, p. 1-18.
– Press: The World, Piauí, and O Dia, ADPF Brazilian Supreme Court Proceedings

2022 Bullock, J. & Pellegrino, A. P. "How do Covid-19 Stay-at-Home Restrictions Affect Crime? Evidence from Rio de Janeiro, Brazil." ***EconomiA*** 22(3): 147-163.

Working Papers

"Under the Radar: How Predatory Policing Distorts the Reporting of Violence against Women." (with Isabella Montini). *Submitted.*

"Criminal Revenue, Civic Returns: How Illicit Taxation Boosts Electoral Participation." *UNU-WIDER Working Paper 86/2025. Submitted.*
– Best Paper Award in the Subnational Politics and Society Section, LASA

"The Electoral Returns to Vote Buying: Evidence from Brazil." (with Almila Basak).

"Venue-Based Sampling: a Practical Tool to Sample Hard-to-Reach Populations in Political Science."

"Bringing the State Back In? The Decline of Criminal Service Provision in Rio de Janeiro." (with Isabella Montini and David Becerra-Medina).

Peer Reviewed Book Chapters

2026 "Criminal Correlates of Extra-Legal Taxation: Evidence from Brazil." (with David Becerra-Medina). *Accepted at Oxford University Press.*
– Working paper version available at: *UNU-WIDER Working Paper 89/2026.*

2020 "How Should Lava Jato End?" (with Matthew Stephenson). In *Corruption and the Lava Jato Scandal in Latin America*, Paul Lagunes and Jen Svenjar (eds.), Routledge.

In Progress

"A Call of Duty? Police Force Formation in Brazil" (with Joana Monteiro, Ana Paula Pellegrino, and Michael Weintraub)

"Strategic Cartography: How Map-Making Can Enable or Obstruct Social Inclusion" (with Ana Paula Pellegrino)

"How to Bribe, Intimidate, and Steal: Evidence from the Fujimori Files"

Software

2026 *bribeR: Tools for Analyzing Vladivideo Transcript Data.* R package version 0.1.0. https://github.com/jessietrudeau/bribeR. (with Andrés Soto Plaza).

Honors and Prizes

2023 Best Dissertation in the Study of Urban Politics, APSA Urban Politics Section
2023 Juan Linz Prize for the Best Dissertation (Runner up), APSA Democracy Section
2022 Franklin L. Burdette Pi Sigma Alpha Best Conference Paper Award, APSA
2022 Best Paper Award, APSA Conflict Processes Section
2022 Elinor and Vincent Ostrom Prize for Best Graduate Student Paper, PCS
2021 Derek Bok Center Certificate of Distinction in Teaching
2020 Subnational Politics & Society Best Paper Award, LASA
2020 Derek Bok Center Certificate of Distinction in Teaching
2019 Weatherhead Center for International Affairs Dissertation Writing Fellowship
2018 Jorge Paulo Lemann Traveling Fellowship
2013-14 Stanford Humanities and Sciences Fellowship
2012 David L. Boren National Security Fellowship, Brazil
2012 Fulbright Teaching Fellowship, Guatemala (declined)
2007-2011 Ingram Scholar, Vanderbilt University

External Funding (as Principal Investigator)

2025 Innovations for Poverty Action: Peace and Recovery, $10,000 (ongoing)
2025 Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean (CAF): Organized crime in Latin America project, $12,000
2024 UNU-WIDER: Statebuilding in conflict-affected contexts: The role of taxation $6,000
2022 Meta Platforms: Public security perceptions in Brazil, $25,000 in ad credits

2020 UNDP: Exploring impact and response to the COVID-19 pandemic in Latin America, data access
2017 CAF: Corruption and Prevention Policies, $10,000

Internal Funding (as Principal Investigator)

2026 Appleby-Mosher Fund for Faculty Research, $1,500
2026 PARCC Mini-Grant Program, $2,000
2026 PLACA Mini-Grant Program, $2,000
2025 Appleby-Mosher Fund for Faculty Research, $2,000
2024 Faculty Creative Activities and Research Program, $5,000
2024 PARCC Mini-Grant Program, $2,500
2023 Appleby-Mosher Fund for Faculty Research, $2,000
2021 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies - Brazil Research Grant, $6,000
2021 Institute for Quantitative Social Science, $3000
2020 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies - Brazil Cities Initiative, $5,000
2020 Foundations of Human Behavior Initiative, $5,000
2020 Institute for Quantitative Social Science, $2,500
2020 Harvard Experimental Working Group, $600
2018 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, $2,000
2018 Foundations of Human Behavior Initiative, $5,000
2017 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, $2,500
2017 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies - Brazil Cities Initiative, $2,500
2017 Institute for Quantitative Social Science, $3,000
2016 David Rockefeller Center for Latin American Studies, $1,900

Policy and Commentary

2026 "Um Complicado Corpo a Corpo." *Piauí.*
2025 Gender-based Violence and Organized Crime. *CAF Policy Document.* (with Isabella Montini).
2024 Episode 3.8: How Criminal Governance Undermines Elections, with Jessie Trudeau. Scope Conditions Podcast interview.
2022 "Lições Pandêmicas para Políticas de Segurança Pública Efetivas." *Nexo Políticas Publicas.* (with Ana Paula Pellegrino).
2021 "Policing or perpetuating violence? State-sanctioned milícias and police in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil." [Review of the book *A República das Milícias: Dos Esquadrões da Morte à Era Bolsonaro*, by B. Paes Manso]. *Criminological Encounters*, 4(1), 179-183.
2021 "Brazilian police killed 27 people in a single raid this month. That doesn't make Rio de Janeiro safer." *The Monkey Cage*, Washington Post.
2021 "Resisting Corruption Along Drug Trafficking Routes: An Analysis of Criminal Justice Bodies in Latin America." Transparency International.
2020 "Corruption and Marginalisation." Transparency International.
2020 "Corruption and Unsolicited Proposals: Risks, Accountability, and Best Practices." Transparency International.
2019 "Best Practices in Civilian Oversight and Whistleblower Protection in the Armed Forces." Transparency International.

Invited Talks and Conferences

2027 University of Iowa (scheduled)

2026 London School of Economics; Harvard University DRCLAS; University of Rochester; Multi-Method Conflict Consortium (M2C2); *Escola Superior de Ministério Público do Brasil* (ESPMU); ESOC Latin America Regional Meeting; REPAL Annual Meeting; ESOC Annual Meeting (scheduled)

2025 Multi-Method Conflict Consortium (M2C2); UNU-WIDER Pathways to State-Building; ESOC Research and Policy; ESOC Annual Meeting

2024 George Washington University; GLD Annual Meeting; ESOC Annual Meeting

2023 Boston University; UPenn Crime and Policing in Comparative Perspective; ESOC Latin America Regional Meeting; REPAL Annual Meeting; Brown University Extra-legal Governance in Global Comparative Perspective

2022 Bocconi; ViCE Seminar Series; KDI; NYU; Brown University; Texas Tech; CIDE; Urban Politics in the Global South Workshop; AL CAPONE Annual Meeting

2021 Georgetown University; Harvard Brazil Studies Program; Texas A&M University; Syracuse University; NEWEPS-17; ESOC Annual Meeting; NYU Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science

2020 Symposium Honoring Robert Bates; Harvard Brazil Studies Program

2019 Cabinet of Rio de Janeiro Dep. Renan Ferreirinha (Brazil); HiCN Annual Meeting; FGV Legal and Economic Research Seminar

2018 CAF Corruption and Prevention Policies Workshop

Affiliations

2026-present Faculty Fellow, Poverty, Violence, and Governance Lab, Stanford University

2026-present Faculty Fellow, Law, Society, and Policy Program, Syracuse University

2024-present Faculty Fellow, Center for Policy Research, Syracuse University

2023-present Senior Research Fellow, Moynihan Institute, Syracuse University

2021-present Affiliated researcher, Fundação Getúlio Vargas, FGV-Cidades

2024-2025 Fellow, Governance and Local Development Institute, University of Gothenburg

2022-23 Fellow, Electoral Integrity Project

Academic Service

Scientific Committee, ESOC Latin America Regional Meeting 2026

Award Committee, APSA Urban Politics Best Dissertation Award, 2024

Award Committee, APSA Conflict Processes Section Best Paper Award, 2023

Scientific Committee, AL CAPONE Annual Meeting, 2023

Award Committee, GI-TOC Best Book Award, 2022

Reviewer for: *American Political Science Review(2); American Journal of Political Science(2), Applied Economics Letters, Comparative Political Studies(2), Dilemas, East Asia Forum(2), International Feminist Journal of Politics, Journal of Politics(3), Journal of Politics in Latin America, Latin American Politics and Society, Perspectives on Politics(3), Political Behavior, Political Psychology, Studies in Comparative International Development, Security Dialogue*

University Service

Founding organizer, Crime, Violence, and Punishment Workshop, Syracuse, 2024-
Organizer, Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse, 2024-
Founding organizer, Latin American Politics Workshop, Syracuse, 2025-
Field Coordinator, Comparative Politics Generals Exams, Syracuse, 2025-2026
Member, Graduate Affairs Committee, Syracuse, 2024-2025
Member, Undergraduate Curriculum Committee, Syracuse, 2023-2024

Teaching

2026 Introduction to Quantitative Political Analysis, Ph.D./Master's seminar
2025 Introduction to Quantitative Political Analysis, Ph.D./Master's seminar
2025 Political Mapping, joint Ph.D./Master's and advanced undergraduate seminar
2025 Global Community, undergraduate lecture
2024 Introduction to Quantitative Political Analysis, Ph.D./Master's seminar
2024 Fighting Crime in Latin America, undergraduate lecture
2023 Crime and Violence, undergraduate lecture
2023 Political Mapping, undergraduate seminar

Additional Training

2024 LAPOP Survey Methods Institute, Vanderbilt University
2023 GIS Institute, Brown University
2016 Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research (IQMR), Syracuse University

Skills

Fieldwork: Brazil (36 months)
Software: ArcGIS, Python, Qualtrics, `R`, Stata
Portuguese: speaking (advanced professional), reading (fluent), writing (advanced professional)
Spanish: speaking (advanced professional), reading (fluent), writing (advanced professional)

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